

Introduce yourself to a person sitting in front, behind or beside you.

What have you found in your stakeholder mapping and power mapping that you found interesting?

Pair & Share

Insights from Stakeholder Mapping

Week 4 Lecture

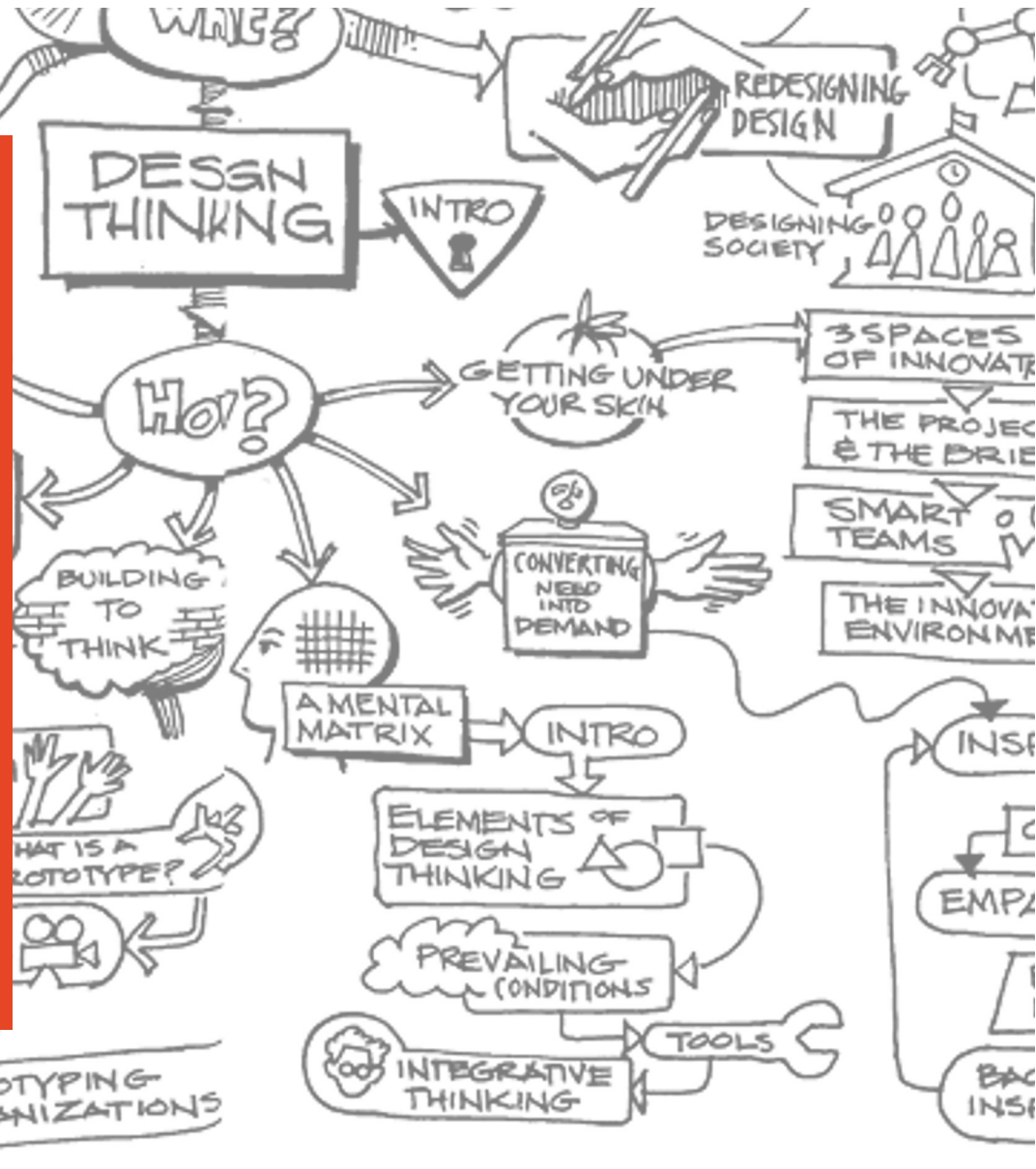
Design Ethics and Ethical Design

IDEA9106 Design Thinking
Semester 2 2026



THE UNIVERSITY OF
SYDNEY

CRT005 00026A



We recognise and pay respect to the Elders and communities – past, present, and emerging – of the lands that the University of Sydney's campuses stand on. For thousands of years they have shared and exchanged knowledges across innumerable generations for the benefit of all.



Overview: Week 4

- Housekeeping
- Design Thinking concepts & theory
- Design Thinking methods & practice
- Wrap Up



Weekly lecture attendance check

- In-person and online attendance, and recorded lecture views are monitored
- Students who attend or watch lecture recordings have a much better understanding of key concepts, and tutorial and assessment requirements
- No mark penalty but you will receive reminder emails about the importance of lectures

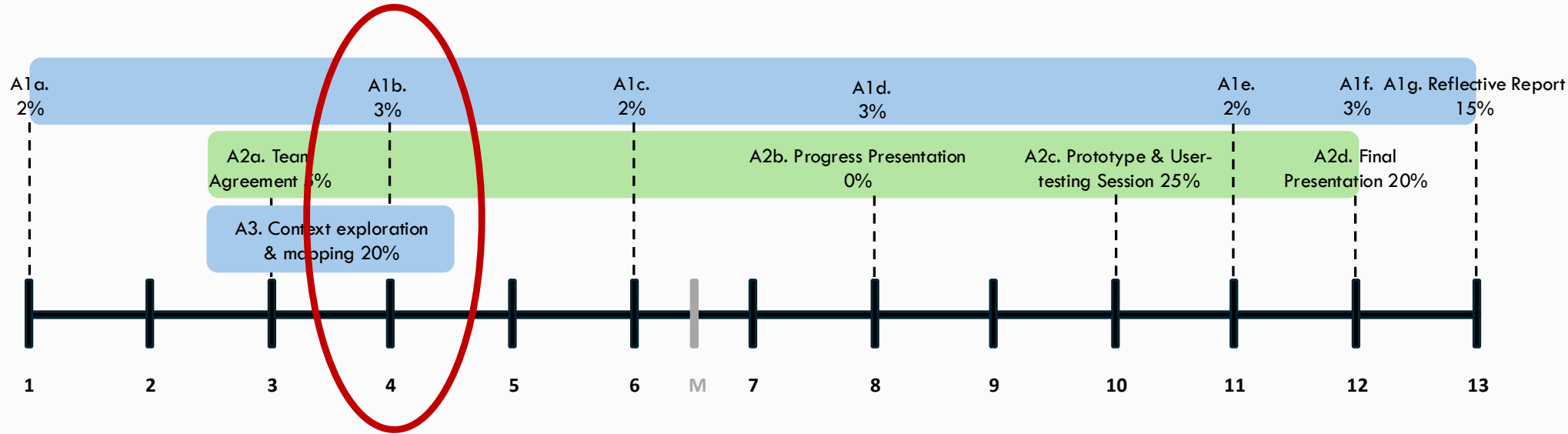


IDEA9106 Assessments Semester 2 2026

All assessments are mandatory

Questionati is the unit's AI for 24/7 answers to assessment questions

Assessments in this unit are connected, building towards A1g. And A2d.



MS: Mindset

PE: Peer & Self evaluation

Individual tasks

Teamwork tasks

A1: Reflective practice

A2: Collaborative learning

A3: Framing and Reframing

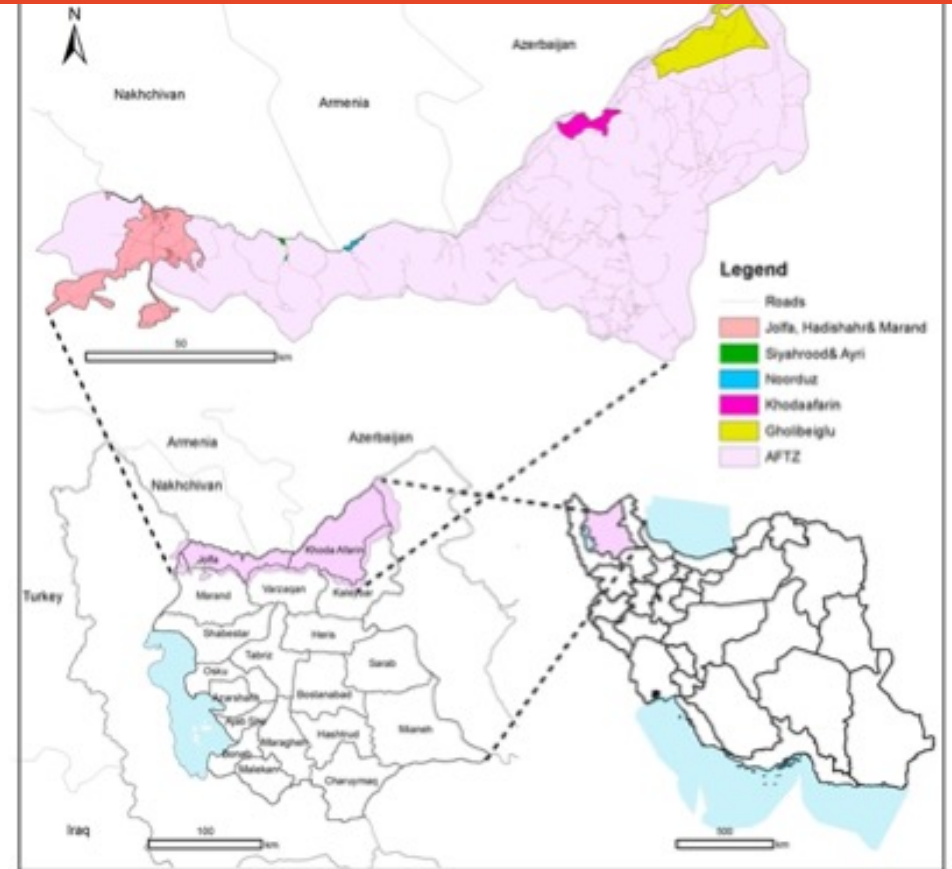
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Khajeh Nazar Carvenserai

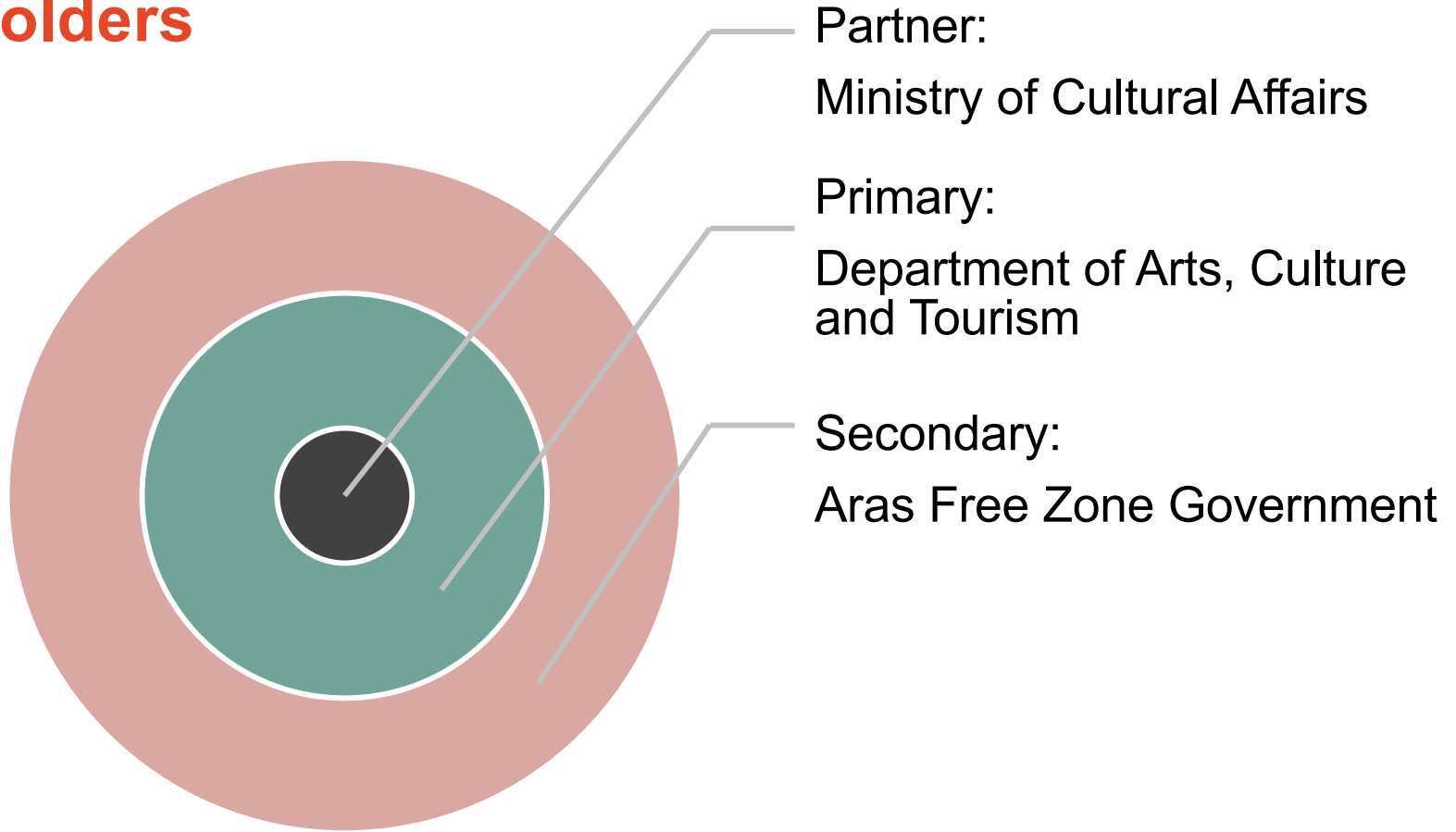
Above a bend in the Aras River, this restored caravanserai has some wonderful views of the eroded red mountains of Iran and across the border to the Nakhchivan enclave of Azerbaijan.



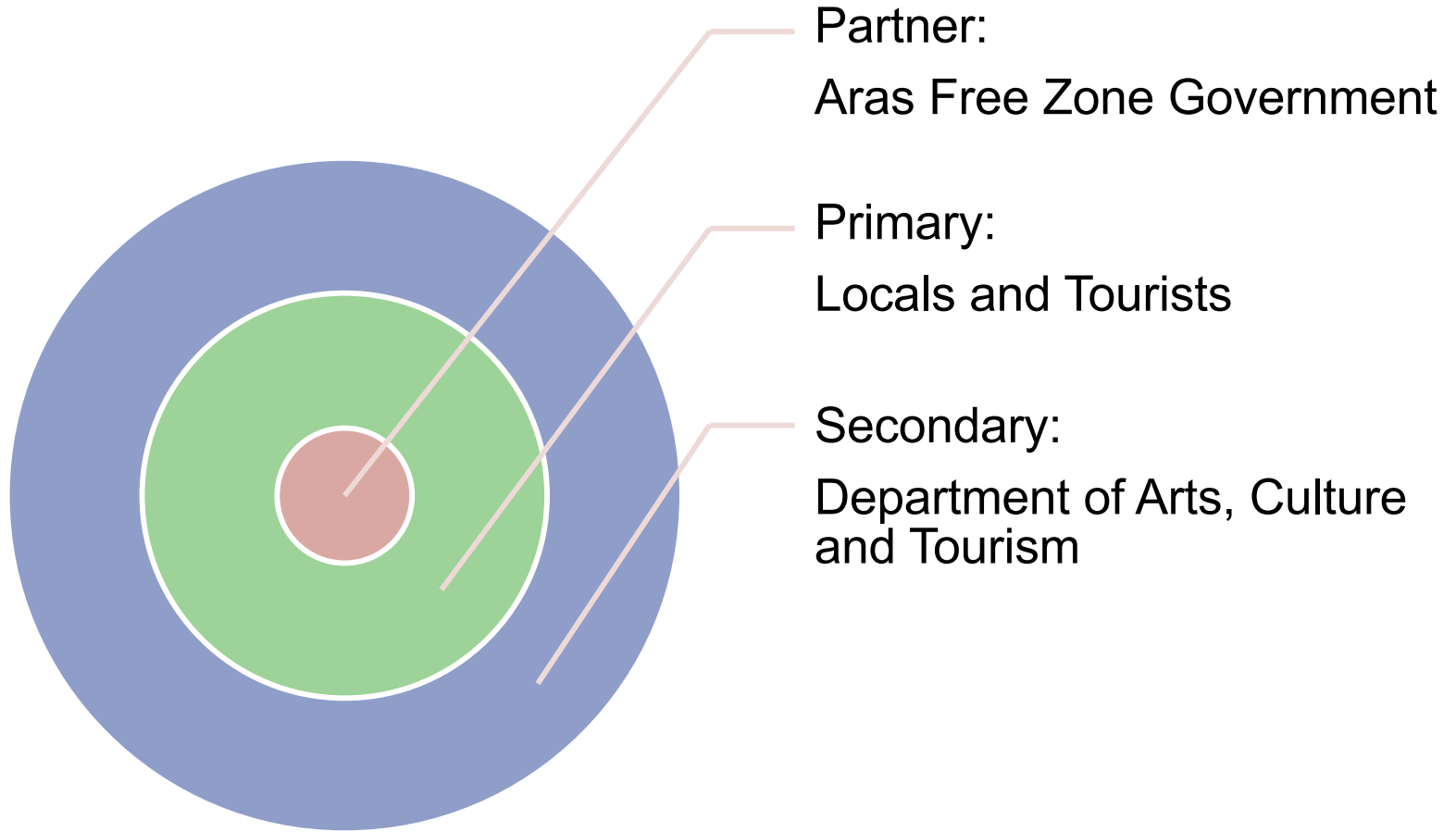
Funding was Granted to Restore the Caravanserai to be Used as an Event Venue for the Government (2014).



An Event Venue: Stakeholders



Let's change this!



Khajeh Nazar Cultural Hub



After the restoration, this project was registered in the UNESCO cultural heritage list along with three other caravanserais in 2023.

Design Shapes More Than Objects: Power, Perception, and People

- Design decisions signal who a space is *for*.
- Inclusive design is not just physical
it's *social, symbolic, and spatial*
- Widening the stakeholder
shifts both outcomes and values

“There are professions more harmful than
industrial design, but only a few.”

— Victor Papanek,
Design for the Real World: Human Ecology and Social Change

The bins

One semester the brief was about reducing single-use cups.

The ideas were not bad.

Nothing the teams proposed cost them anything.



Ideas and ideals

- An **idea** is a move you make in the world
- An **ideal** is the picture of a better world you are moving towards.
- **Ideas** belong to the project. The **ideal** is yours, and it arrives first.

**In design, we are dealing with wicked problems.
An idea with no ideal behind it has nothing to be
judged against.**

It can be clever. But it cannot be good.

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An idea with no ideal behind it has nothing to be
judged against.**

It can be clever. But it cannot be good.

The direction runs from the ideal to the idea.

What you leave out

- What you include is what you would like to be true of yourself
- What you left out is where you actually stand
- Every map you drew this semester stopped somewhere, and you did not experience it as a decision

You do not choose. You *satisfice*.

Having a position, not the right one

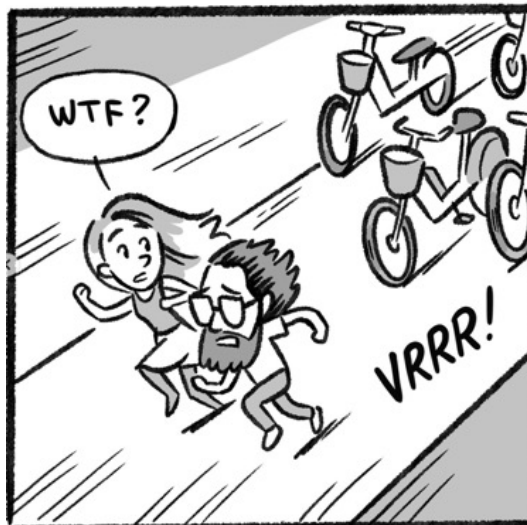
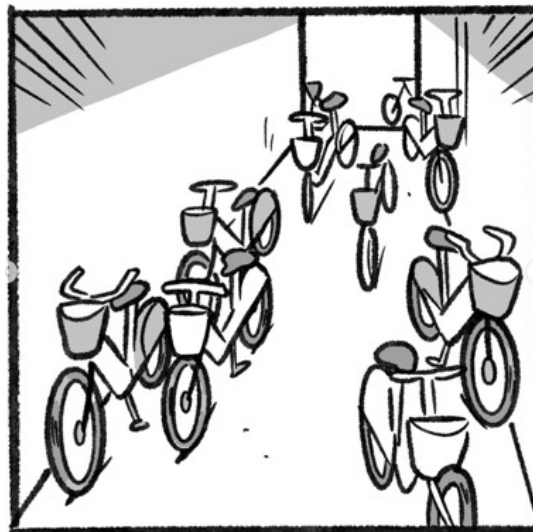
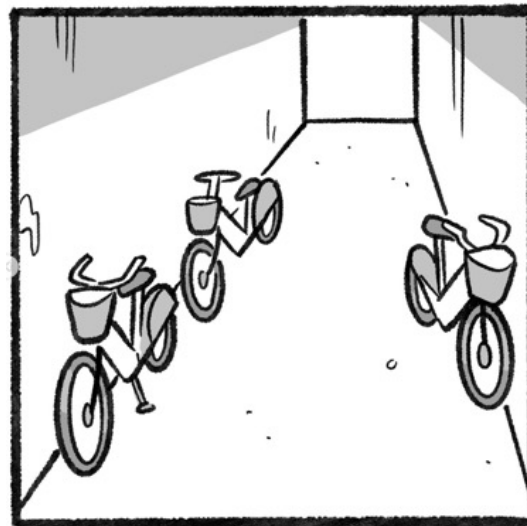
- There is no correct set of values
- An unstated position cannot be consulted, argued with, tested or revised
- An unstated position is often lost against a deadline.

Think about the consequences instead.

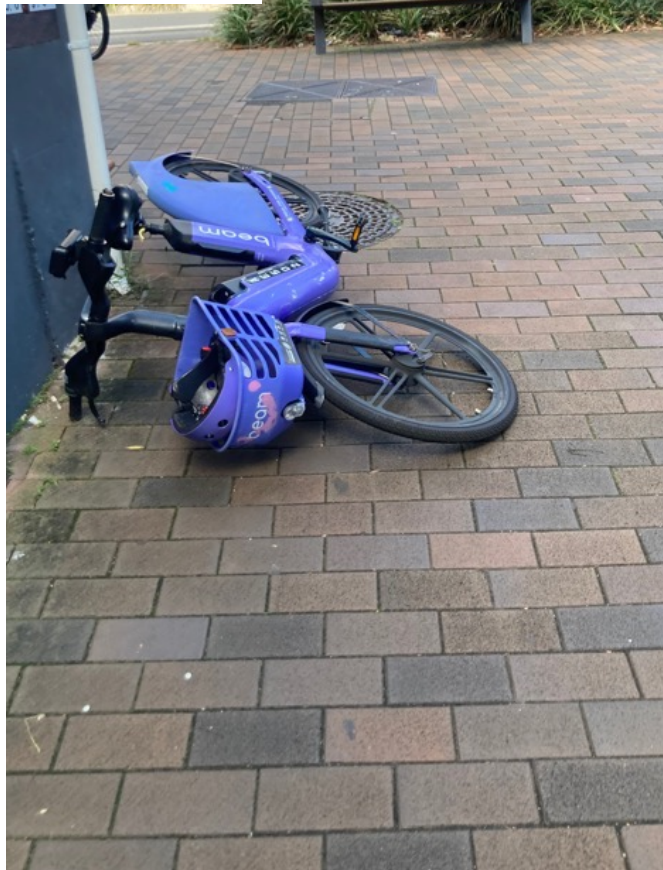
- What are the **intended and unintended consequences** of this product or feature?
- What are the **positive consequences** we want to focus on?
- What are the **unwanted consequences** we want to prevent?
- **Who is excluded** by your design decisions even if unintentionally?

Example: Shared City Bikes





Example: Shared City Bikes



Design Impact

Good intentions are not enough !!

A design creates:

- **First-order effects:** the direct intended outcome.
- **Second-order effects:** changes in behaviour, routines, or relationships.
- **Third-order effects:** wider cultural, social, environmental, or systemic consequences.

Typical Traps

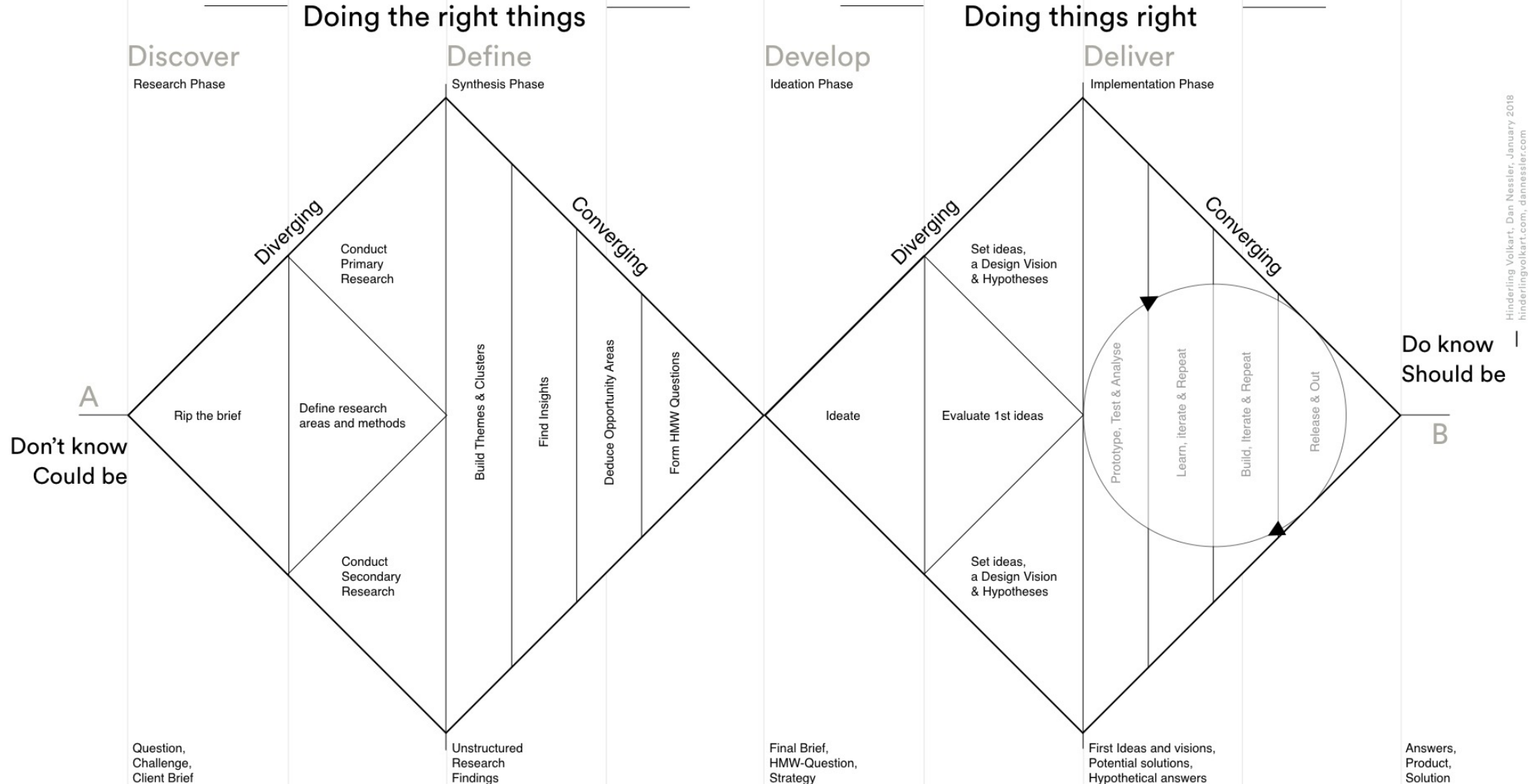
- **Solving the visible symptom.** You frame the obvious surface issue, not the deeper condition underneath it.
- **Solving for one stakeholder only.** You satisfy the client or primary user while passing costs onto others.
- **Treating harm as someone else's problem.** You focus on use but ignore access, exclusion, sustainability, or long-term effects.

Overview: Week 4

- Theory: why a position is unavoidable
- **Methods: instruments for stating one**
- Wrap Up



Revamped Double Diamond



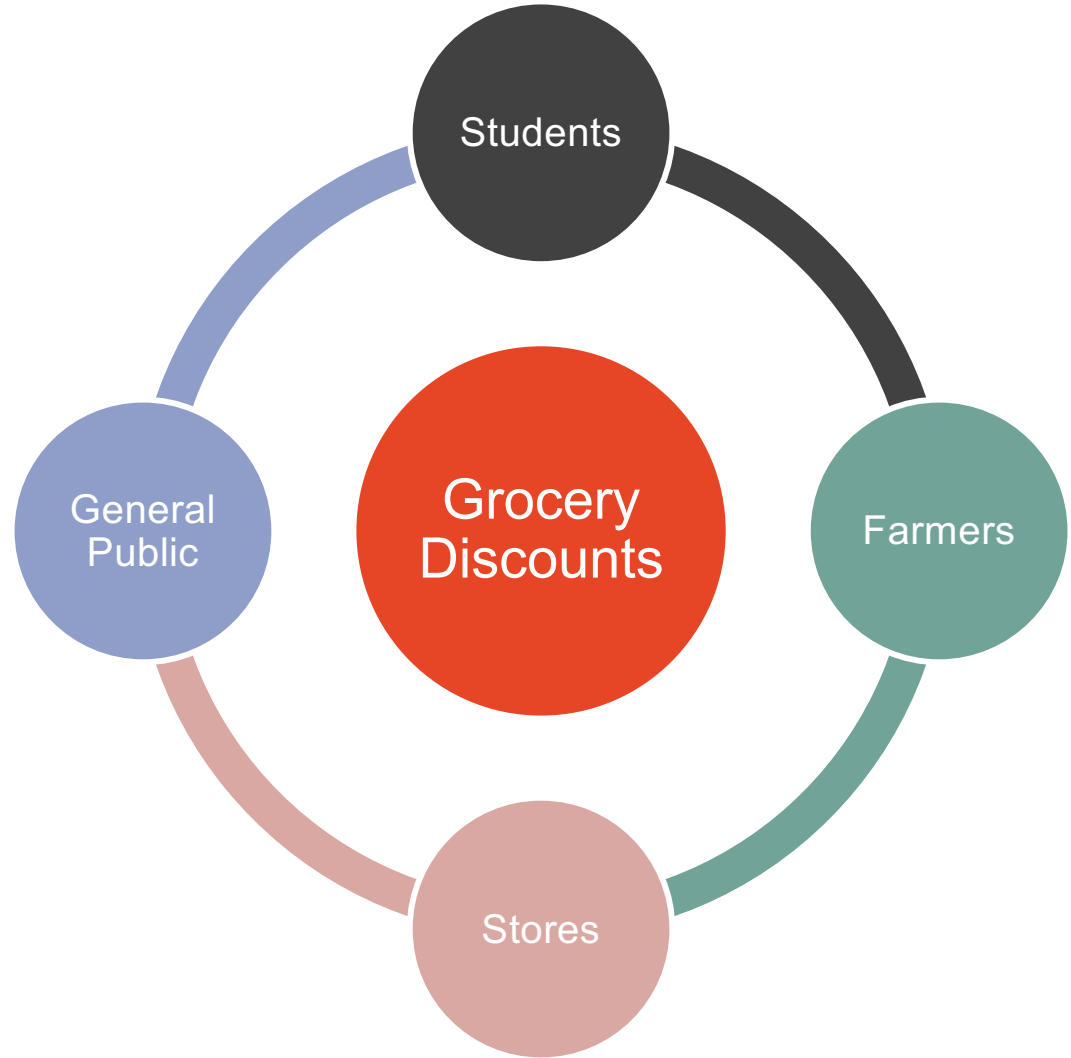
Example: The Cost of Living for University Students.

Student Discounts
on Groceries and
Essential Goods.



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Tools you already own

- The stakeholder map, Week 2
- The power map, Week 2
- The risk matrix, Week 3
- Taught as descriptions of a situation. Also records of where you were standing

The cartouche, this week's tutorial

- The other three map the situation. This one maps the instrument
- Write down the two values you rejected last. They tell you more than the six.
- If your value is not in the set, add it. Somebody built that set from somewhere.

Three things a stated position does

- Lets you accept a project for a reason, not out of availability
- Lets you refuse in terms someone else can hear
- Lets you notice that you have moved

Ethics begins in the problem side.

Problem Statement:

- what matters? • who matters?
- what gets ignored?

The way you frame the problem is already a design decision.



**WHAT YOU DO MAKES A
DIFFERENCE, AND YOU HAVE
TO DECIDE WHAT KIND OF
DIFFERENCE YOU WANT TO MAKE.**

– JANE GOODALL

Recap

- Design is never neutral
- Ethical design means mapping competing interests, not choosing a favourite
- Short-term wins can create long-term harm. Evaluate across time
- Unintended consequences are still yours
- Invisible stakeholders matter: the environment, the labour, the people never seen

That's the end of today's lecture.

We'll see you in tutorials.

Find your class location here:



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